Alexey Zarakovskiy

Senior Backend & Platform Engineer

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Fluent: English, Russian
Proficient: Dutch, Spanish & Polish

EU Citizen

Language and technology agnostic. *Nothing-is-impossible* mindset.

Golang · Java · Kotlin · Python · PHP · Javascript · Typescript · React

Kubernetes · AWS · GCP · Docker · Kafka · DynamoDB · PostgreSQL · Elasticsearch · Protobuf

AWS CDK · Prometheus · Grafana · Datadog · Gitlab CI/CD · ArgoCD · Testcontainers · AI agents

Projects & Experience

Sabbatical *· Focus on family and deep-dive into AI engineering · Jan 2026 - Mar 2026*

Personio · European HR platform serving 12k+ customers · Mar 2023 - Dec 2025 · Amsterdam

Senior Backend Engineer · 2 yrs 10 mos

Whistleblowing (Golang, 0→1):

- Architected and launched a greenfield EU-compliant Whistleblowing service. Designed a dual-AWS infrastructure and anonymous authentication to ensure full anonymity and regulatory isolation.

- Led a virtual team of 3 engineers to maintain the service post-launch; 99.92% uptime with latency p99<200ms; resolved 14 critical security vulnerabilities.

- Established automated testing via Docker Testcontainers and Datadog synthetic monitoring.

- Guided the organizational adoption of the Golang stack and its best practices.

Surveys (Kotlin):

- Led major platform features such as a dashboard revamp (major API change), a user data snapshot tool preventing exponential database growth, questions result categorization (remodeling abstraction for existing data), date-driven filters (dynamic user-specific search filter values).

- Identified an issue with user data snapshots, and owned zero-downtime migration of 24Gb dataset.

- Reduced latency across 14 mission-critical endpoints by optimizing DB indexes and schema; cutting P99 from 600ms to <300ms.

Golang · Kotlin · Kubernetes · AWS & AWS CDK · PostgreSQL · Docker · Kafka · Protobuf · Typescript · ArgoCD

BEAT | FREENOW · Ride-hailing platform with 250k+ drivers · Sep 2019 - Jan 2023 · Amsterdam

Senior Backend (Golang) Engineer · 3 yrs 4 mos

Pricing service (Golang):

- Spearheaded the microservices migration of the core pricing engine out of the monolith.

- Implemented dynamic pricing engine using hexagonal geo-zones, introducing incentive-driven drivers supply & demand pricing across multiple markets.

API Gateway & Authentication service (Golang):

- Engineered an API gateway (10k+ RPS) and a high-throughput authentication service (DynamoDB) as a replacement for existing implementation in the monolith; running both side-by-side during migration.

- Introduced custom K8s CRDs for dynamic API registration and a Go authorization library adopted by all 7 cross-functional teams. This decentralized routing and authorization concerns, and simplified the company-wide migration from a PHP monolith to microservices.

- Contributed to Skipper framework (OSS) to enable the flexibility required for CRD-based routing.

- Implemented idempotency guard using Redis, enforcing one-time use for JWT email signup tokens.

- Implemented containerized integration testing for routing and auth behavior during migration.

Golang · Kubernetes · AWS · DynamoDB · Redis · Docker · Kafka · PHP · Protobuf

fashionTrade · Early-stage B2B fashion marketplace · May 2018 - Jul 2019 · Amsterdam

Senior Java Engineer · 1 yr 3 mos

- Designed a distributed API for data integration serving hundreds of fashion wholesalers. This enabled automated sync between master data and customer datasets.

- Managed async data ingestion, fuzzy matching with Elasticsearch, and Kafka event streams to handle race conditions.

Java · Python · REST · Docker · Kafka · GCP · Kubernetes · Elasticsearch

SDL Web · Open-source adapter framework for an enterprise CMS · Oct 2015 - Apr 2018 · Amsterdam

Technical Team Lead · 11 mos; Senior Java Engineer · 1 yr 8 mos

- Led development of open-source Java framework for an enterprise CMS.

- Implemented reflection-based dynamic model mapping, reducing third-party integration time.

- Reviewed and integrated contributions from the community.

Java · Spring · Maven · Gradle · Open-source · C#.NET

EPAM Systems · (Senior) Full-stack Engineer (Java) · 2012 - 2015 · 3 yrs · Russia → Poland & Germany

Delivering enterprise solutions for clients like Yota (Russia), PayPal (US) and MeteoSystems (Germany).

L.I.C. · Workflow automation system · Full-stack Engineer (Java) · 2011 - 2012 · 1 yr 1 mos · Russia

Orange · Web development · Full-stack (PHP) / PM / Co-founder · 2009 - 2011 · 2 yrs 1 mos · Russia

State factory · Real-time monitoring software · C++ / C# Developer · Jul 2006 - Jun 2009 · 3 yrs · Russia

Education

ITMO University, Master in Computer Science · 2005 - 2011 · Russia

UX Design Essentials Course, Exigen Services · 2011 · Russia